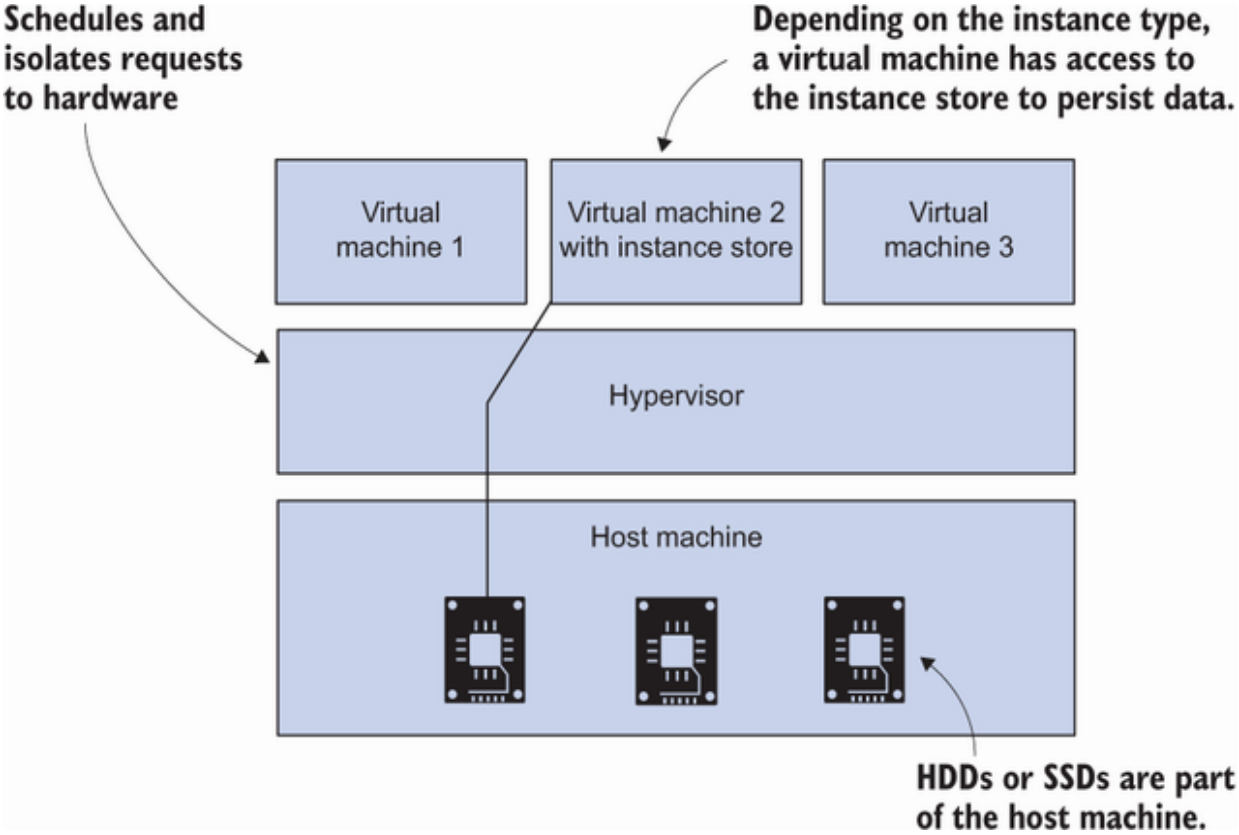


Figure 8.2 The instance store is part of your EC2 instance and uses the host machine's HDDs or SSDs.

In comparison to an EBS volume, which is connected to your EC2 instance over the network, the instance store depends upon the EC2 instance and can't exist without it. The instance store will be deleted when you stop or terminate the virtual machine.

Don't use an instance store for data that must not be lost; use it for temporary data only. For example, it is not a big deal to cache data on instance store, because you are able to restore the data from its origin anytime.

In rare cases, it is also advisable to persist data on instance storage, such as whenever the application is replicating data among multiple